

FOREVER MY PARENT

A Grief Journal for Adult Children Who Lost a Parent

A space to remember, grieve,
and carry their love forward

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THE UNIQUE GRIEF OF LOSING A PARENT

Losing a parent changes you at your core. It doesn't matter if you were 25 or 55 when it happened. Something fundamental shifts when the person who brought you into this world leaves it.

This grief is unique because:

- They knew you from your very beginning
- They were your first model of love (imperfect as it may have been)
- Part of your identity was built in relationship to them
- You may now feel like an 'adult orphan' - untethered
- Every milestone from now on will have their absence

This journal is for you to:

- Process the waves of grief as they come
- Preserve memories before they fade
- Say the things left unsaid
- Find ways to carry their love forward
- Give yourself permission to grieve YOUR way

There is no timeline for this. There is no 'getting over it.'

There is only learning to carry this love-turned-grief alongside everything else in your life.

Write when you're ready. Skip days when you're not.

This journal will wait for you.

Day 1

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: What I wish I could ask you today...

Day 2

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: A lesson you taught me that I carry every day...

Day 3

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: Holiday traditions I want to keep alive...

Day 4

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: How I see you in myself (mannerisms, habits, values)...

Day 5

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: Things I never got to say to you...

Day 6

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: How I'm honoring your memory this week...

Day 7

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: A smell, sound, or place that brings you back to me...

Day 8

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: What I wish I could ask you today...

Day 9

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: Something funny I remember about you...

Day 10

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: What I miss most about our everyday life...

Day 11

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: A lesson you taught me that I carry every day...

Day 12

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: How I wish you could see my life now...

Day 13

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: Holiday traditions I want to keep alive...

Day 14

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: The hardest part of grief today...

Day 15

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: How I see you in myself (mannerisms, habits, values)...

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: Something I'm grateful you gave me...

Day 17

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: Things I never got to say to you...

Day 18

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: A time you made me feel completely loved...

Day 19

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: How I'm honoring your memory this week...

Day 20

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: What I want my children to know about you...

Day 21

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: What I wish I could ask you today...

Day 22

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: A tradition or recipe of yours I'll never let die...

Day 23

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: A lesson you taught me that I carry every day...

Day 24

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: How grief surprised me today...

Day 25

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: Holiday traditions I want to keep alive...

Day 26

Date: / /

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: Your voice - what I remember you saying...

Day 27

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: How I see you in myself (mannerisms, habits, values)...

Day 28

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: What I'm learning about myself through this grief...

Day 29

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: Things I never got to say to you...

Day 30

Date: ____/____/____

Missing you level today (1-10): ____

Today's prompt: How I'm honoring your memory this week...

FIRST HOLIDAYS WITHOUT THEM

The firsts are the hardest. Give yourself permission to do these
YOUR way - not how everyone expects you to.

THEIR BIRTHDAY:

How I want to honor it: _____

MAJOR HOLIDAYS:

What I want to keep: _____

What I need to change: _____

Who I want to be with: _____

ANNIVERSARY OF THEIR PASSING:

How I want to spend this day: _____

MY BIRTHDAY / MILESTONES:

How I'll include their memory: _____

PERMISSION SLIPS:

- I'm allowed to be sad at celebrations
- I'm allowed to be happy on hard days
- I'm allowed to skip traditions that hurt too much
- I'm allowed to create new traditions
- I'm allowed to cry in public without apology

